

New job opportunities for recent graduates.

Handy Manny

Had their unlimited PTO rejected

Dear Recent Graduates,

Now that we have your attention, have you made your way into the terrifying depths of the real world? Do you long for the days when the biggest fear was looking at your grades instead of making a mistake on your taxes and being arrested? Whether you escaped Pittsburgh or are still creeping around this city like a stalker at parties, you are now officially old and withering away. The sweet embrace of Wean Hall during Carnival season is your highlight of the year, and it's time to accept that.

You aren't getting any younger, no matter how much you try to escape the fleeting feeling of loneliness. That one person in your class is now a multi-billionaire, while you are stuck working at a weapons manufacturer building the bombs that our government used a week ago. All you can do is sit there and give an update, making the meaningless work you do sound interesting on LinkedIn.

We sympathize with your pain, so we suggest that, as a way to relive the memories of yonder, you should donate to the KGB, so we can have fun in your place. Whether you made fun of the KGB in the past, we do not care; the only thing we care about is having basic amenities like fighter jets and indoor trampoline parks.

While we may not be able to give you a graduation ceremony for you 2020 grads, or give the 2025 grads a connection so they can actually get employed somewhere, we can repeatedly ask for donations. In fact, after you donate online to us, we will remind you of that email and the deadline due next week, free of charge!

Best

The Readme Editorial Committee

A Grad Student's Guide to Carnival

WP
Old

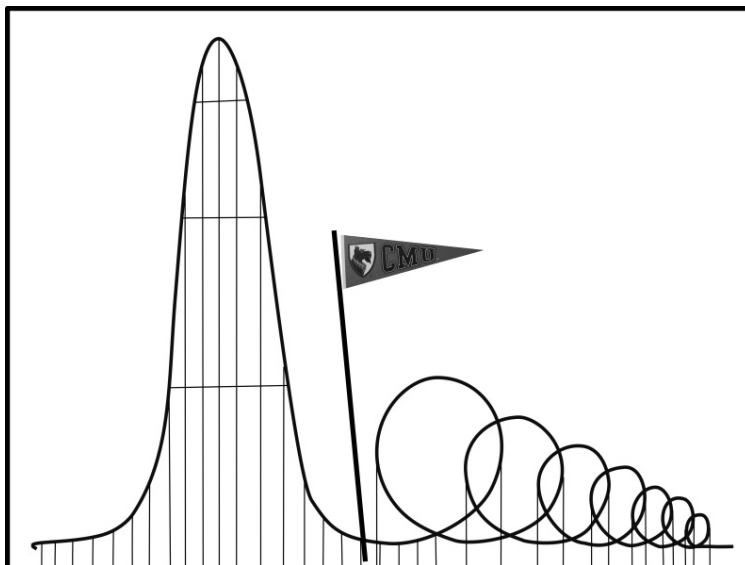
Me and the freshman from the other page have one thing in common: we have never been to Spring Carnival. If you're a first year Master's student, you need to lock in, because there's a good chance your program (which also has a 1 in 5 chance of having the word "AI" in it) runs for three semesters. This means that this might be your one and only chance to participate in Carnival as a student. If you're a Ph.D. student, why are you reading this? Go back to your lab, bitch. If you did your undergrad here and came back for more, fuck you for being smarter than me.

The trick to enjoying Carnival is to never forget the cardinal rule of graduate school: you are Old. Your age doesn't matter, and I would like to point out that this is the only context in which you get to use that phrase. You could be 21, freshly out of undergrad, and younger than current seniors. Doesn't matter. You are Old. The faster you accept this, the higher your chance of being able to enjoy yourself. Being Old shifts how people look at you for doing certain things because you're expected to have some of your shit together. A good example of this is day drinking. Be a responsible adult: hide your vodka in a water bottle, and be discreet about it. You are past the age where people will trust you enough to take a swig from it, anyway.

This leads to the next point of

Carnival. How do you bond with the undergraduates here? For the first time, you might have to interact with the half of the school's population that you've managed to avoid. Fortunately for you, I have spent the better part of the year working undercover at this awful campus publication in order to figure them out. My research has led me to one conclusion: they are people too. They might be a bit smarter or richer than you, but that doesn't change the fact that you should treat them like you would a normal person. If you want to be friendly and get some good memories from this event, be yourself! Being mean to people has never led me astray. Don't let self-doubt get in the way of you walking up to a teenager and telling them that their parents don't love them, or asking if they're "supposed to look like that." People will find you hilarious.

That being said, if you're a student in a short program, you don't really have the option to be able to bounce back from a terrible semester. That means that if you're already stressed out, you might feel the urge to skip out on everything, and not even waste an hour strolling on the lawn admiring the commotion. Listen to that urge. When your time comes, you'll want to rest assured knowing that you got through graduate school without a single "B". Nobody has ever laid on their deathbed and gone, "Man, I wish I had done more things."



New Carnival Event
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With MECHE Students!

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Nine-and-a-half theses on comedy

Bertie Wooster
In nomine comoedia

1. When the humorist writes, he ought to will the entire piece be one of intelligibility.
2. Satire cannot be understood as merely the presence of references and proper nouns; artificial intelligence, Farnam Jahanian, Palantir, and Charlie Kirk do not a joke make.
3. When references are to be made, timeliness is of utmost importance.
4. More generally, timing is essential. In writing, this is achieved through punchiness and restraint.
5. They preach only false doctrines who teach that a sentence becomes funnier by being made longer, stranger, and more subordinatedly claused.
6. A joke explained is a joke better left unstated.
7. Similarly, it is certain that a joke, once made, need not be again in the following sentence, nor in the sentence after that, nor as a concluding callback whose only merit is persistence.
8. Those satirists are in error who say that if a line is weak, it may be redeemed by placing it within quotation marks and attributing it to a sophomore in SCS.
9. No rule of humor is firmly true and to attempt matters of the heart is ever difficult.
- 9.5. Blessed be all those who attempt humor, however feeble.



This issue of readme is brought to you by:

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As always: Brought to you by the CMU KGB. See ya next time!

The Tell-Tale Tartan

Bertie Wooster
Thief Extraordinaire

The idea first entered with levity.

A prank, someone said.

A joke, said another.

A bit, I asserted, and all agreed this was the fairest possible framing.

This was no exercise in greed. I desired not money and, indeed, am hardly starved of such, given my Californian parentage. Power neither did I want, for there is little to be gained by dominion over sporadically published gratis periodicals (which happen to serve chiefly as insulation, kindling, and versatile booth-construction material). No, I think it was the spirit of the thing: their hateful abundance! Those neat little stacks at dawn, those smug rectangular towers scarcely diminished by evening, those lavish budgets, all this pomp for some extraordinarily laughable publication – and on April Fools, it was meant to be especially laughable – for alongside those Tartans and Pillboxes, were to be the reverse: Natrats and Sexobllip; ostensibly serious journalism was to be complemented by allegedly humorous writing.

Observe now how methodologically we proceeded. We rose at five in the morning, an hour reserved for airport departures, buggy competitors, and the clinically unwell. We rendezvoused in the blue-grey predawn with the enthusiasm of those about to embark on something great and amusing. The mood was initially exuberant, subdued only by the weariness infusing every action and statement.

Two hours, we lurked. For, foolish as we were, we presumed the papers would be out by six, as is their wont; but hasty – too hasty by far! – were we. Breakfast was difficult: our anticipation curdled into nerves, our nerves into dread, our dread into anticipation again, and so forth in increasingly brief cycles. At last the time fell with a papery plop as we observed Tartans unceremoniously dropped onto a stand. With a graceful swiftness that would move angels and bank robbers alike to tears unlike, we descended.

My dear reader, we cleaned them out.

Two thousand five hundred Tartans.

Two thousand five hundred Natrats.

Two thousand five hundred Pillboxes.

Two thousand five hundred Sexobllip.

We took them all – or nearly all (indeed, I must digress here to crow that the Tartan's staff believed we had made a comprehensive job of it, despite the fact that perhaps hundreds remained marooned in obscure nooks and random crannies across campus) – in armfuls and backpacks and the belief of something greater.

Our spoils were deposited in, of all places, my dorm room. There, they all lay in great accusatory heaps. It was no longer possible to sit still naturally: my chair rolled with a newfound resistance, the air itself had become papery and opening the window threatened an avalanche of such scale I might only have been found months later among then-vintage kindling.

Despite this, we exulted, taking photos with the exuberance of tourists at the Louvre. After all, the quantity was admirable, naturally, but so was our bravado; our ruthless, secret efficiency; and, above all, the absolute and undeniable stupidity of it all: for is not college to be spent on wasteful trivialities that amount to a thing of beauty?

Soon came word that the Tartan's membership believed the disappearance had been the fault of their new printing company (and, to their credit, this did explain the initial delay in distribution). They were, we learned, considering demanding a refund. A refund!

Reader, you must try to imagine my torment (for it is one you doubtless and hopefully have never experienced). There are crimes against persons, crimes against property, crimes against humanity, and, above all, there is the unique and unbearable moral transgression of accidentally causing undergraduate editorial staff to send a sternly worded email. This, we could not allow and we reached out anonymously to an intermediary, the officer in charge of the Tartan's communications, confessing the whole affair was nothing more than a foolish April Fools' prank.

For our troubles came the threat of police action. For what? For larceny of the complimentary? For aggravated overcollection? For daring the Tartan to be funny? In point of fact, we were intending to only carry out the heist should the Natrat be hideously unfunny – which, admittedly, was a certainty – and, indeed, our ransom note – had events progressed that far – was to be nothing more than a few points on humor – nine point five theses on comedy, to be precise – and an apology.

But nonetheless we agreed to replace what we had displaced.

There is no dignity in undoing a prank; once more we became beasts of burden, staggering under the weight of their ideas. Despite our redresses, we expected further condemnation, perhaps fury. Bizarrely though, we were asked to stop halfway through.

"Why?" you ask. I hear you and, though it pains me, tell you it was due to a misprint – they planned to reprint the issue anyway.

Can you comprehend the abyss that opened up in my soul? We had not interrupted the stream of the Natrat's relentless history (incidentally, this august tradition has only been interrupted twice before, in 1994 and 2004, but modesty forbids me from saying more).

Anyway, what a waste of time it had been!

And yet – and yet! – was it not beautiful?

For what is Carnegie Mellon if not overengineered uselessness: spending hours on a project only to realize it had been rendered irrelevant; working and working and working and, ultimately, pranking only yourself? In the end, no, they still are not funny, whether intentionally or otherwise; but we were – whether intentionally or otherwise – and that is enough.